



Improvised explosives

A US soldier lies wounded by a Viet Cong booby trap made from white phosphorus scavenged from unexploded American ordnance. White phosphorus grenades were widely used to hit Viet Cong tunnel networks.

Operation Ranch Hand

In the 1960s, the Army Chemical Corps was charged with protecting US personnel from chemical attack, but also with perfecting and deploying chemical weapons. In Vietnam, the Chemical Corps partnered with the Air Force to conduct Operation Ranch Hand—the aerial spraying of chemical defoliants on forests and farmland from 1961 to 1971, with the stated aim of killing roadside vegetation, defoliating jungle hiding enemy troops, and destroying civilian crops suspected of being grown for enemy use.

“Beautiful shade **trees** along the streets in ...
Da Nang are **dead or dying.**”

LIEUTENANT COLONEL JIM COREY, DEPUTY CHIEF OF CORDS, TO HIS SUPERIORS, MARCH 1969